



# General Working Practices

## Time zones

- CPCS works internationally and we manage teams, people, clients and projects across time zones. We aim to respond to colleagues and clients with speed and efficiency.
- Working across time zones requires setting fair meeting times so that colleagues are not regularly taking meetings outside their working hours.
- All employees are required to consider their colleagues' working time zones when setting meeting times and sending emails, and wherever possible, must only diarise meetings that fall within shared normal working hours.
- Employees are not expected to send and respond to emails outside their normal working hours.
- See also: [Working remotely across time zones](#)

## Cultural awareness

Be aware of a country's cultural norms and traditions. Cultural differences can dictate the working hours and patterns of colleagues or clients as well as the holidays celebrated.

## Lunch time

A lunch break is important. Avoid as much as possible scheduling internal meetings between 1 to 2 p.m.

## Contacting part-time employees

- If you're an employee working part-time, indicate in your calendar when you're not working so that colleagues do not contact you unless it's for emergencies, which they'll do by telephone.
- Part-time employees are not expected to reply to emails when they're not working.

## Not working? Set an out-of-office message

Employees are expected to set their out-of-office message when they're not working. Your automated reply must list the details of an emergency contact who you have obtained permission from and who is working during your absence.

## The Right to Disconnect Policy

Employees have the right to disconnect from their job and any work-related tasks or communication outside of working hours without fear of reprisal.

Normal business hours in a team member's home jurisdiction are the default basis for establishing working hours (for example, in Ontario, this would be 8:30 am to 5:00pm according to [CTL working hours](#)). However, employees may discuss and mutually agree on alternative working hours with their manager, should it be preferable that working hours differ from normal business hours.

The right to disconnect means that employees:

- Can stop performing their job duties and work-related tasks when they are not expected to work;
- Are not expected or required to respond to work-related communication outside their scheduled working hours, while on break, or during any paid or unpaid time off;
- Will not face repercussion or be penalized for not communicating or continuing to work outside of their scheduled working hours.

Employees must also be respectful of others' right to disconnect and should not expect their co-workers to respond, communicate, or complete work when not working.

To be clear, nothing in this policy precludes an employee to work outside of working hours if they so wish.

## **No Smoking Policy**

In accordance with the law our premises, including the roof terrace, are no smoking zones. Breach of the rules is considered to be gross misconduct and can lead to summary dismissal. This includes the use of e-cigarettes and vaporisers.

## **Dress code**

Our normal dress policy is business smart-casual and formal business dress where appropriate; we dress appropriately for the daily interactions among employees, clients, prospects and other visitors.

## **Company property**

All equipment which you use or has been issued to you to perform your job is owned by CPCS. It is your responsibility to care for and safeguard CPCS' property, including equipment, whether you are at the CPCS' premises, travelling or at a client's site.

To reduce the risk of loss, damage or theft outside the workplace you must not leave portable items on view in your vehicle. If you are leaving the vehicle for a short period of time and can do so, you should lock portable items in the boot of the vehicle, out of sight. If you are leaving the vehicle for a longer period, an overnight stay or there is no boot on your vehicle, you must remove items from the vehicle and take them with you.

CPCS reserves the right to recover the cost of lost, damaged or stolen Company property from you.

## **Personal property**

Personal property is your responsibility and CPCS will not be held responsible for loss of or damage to personal property and therefore we ask that you:

- Please keep the items of value you bring to work to a minimum
- Please ensure you have insurance cover to cover any losses that you may sustain